

Chapter 25-8

The dishes on the table were delicious, and Liang Shi also politely only touched the one or two dishes in front of her.

There was a crystal aspic in front of her. Seeing the little girl across from her staring at it longingly, she originally didn't want to meddle, but because the little girl's eyes looked so pitiful, she couldn't help herself and used the serving chopsticks to put some in the little girl's bowl.

Although Lingdang liked this dish, because it was served by Liang Shi, she wasn't sure whether she should eat it.

She looked at Liang Shi hesitantly, and Liang Shi gave her a gentle smile, "Go ahead and eat."

Second Sister-in-law beside her also patted her head, "What should Lingdang say?"

Lingdang was clever and smiled: "Thank you, Aunt."

Liang Shi was unconsciously infected by her smile, and her tone became lighter too, "It's nothing."

Children generally don't hold grudges.

If you treat them slightly better, even if there were unpleasant incidents before, they'll forget about them.

Lingdang was just like that.

After that, Liang Shi helped her with dishes several more times, and her voice became even sweeter.

Second Sister-in-law even said: "Shi, eat your own food, don't worry about her."

"It's fine, I'm full." Liang Shi said: "I had breakfast."

It was only just past twelve o'clock now. She had eaten a sandwich around nine, and hadn't done any strenuous exercise afterward, so she wasn't very hungry.

Second Sister-in-law didn't say anything more.

But Liang Xinhe turned to look at her and said quietly: "What a transformation, even getting up early now."

Liang Shi: "..."

She suspected this second brother couldn't speak without being sarcastic.

But at the dinner table, she didn't retort either, just shrugged to indicate yes.

This topic was just brushed aside like that.

This meal was somewhat oppressive. Although they were supposedly eating a reunion dinner to celebrate Liang Xinzhou's birthday, everyone at the table didn't talk much. It wasn't lively at all, and was even quiet enough that you could hear the sound of chopsticks touching plates.

Liang Shi felt even more like she had thorns on her back¹.

It must be the karma from the original owner being too high-profile.

When she was eating, the servants' gazes were probably all focused on her.

After the meal, Father Liang chatted with Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe about company matters for a while.

The others sat there doing their own things, in various poses.

Later, Father Liang suggested that the family go play golf. There was a huge golf course behind the villa.

Liang Shi followed along to see what it was like.

Her golf was mediocre. To be precise, she wasn't very good at any ball sports.

From what she knew, the original owner wasn't very good either.

Although she was an Alpha, she often didn't exercise.

She didn't even have abs.

She idly wasted the entire afternoon until after five o'clock, when everyone finally returned indoors together.

Dinner was at seven. Father Liang said he was tired now and wanted to return to his room to rest.

Everyone else also went back to their respective rooms.

Liang Shi finally figured out the pattern - everything in this house was decided by Father Liang.

Qiu Zimin was very silent in front of Father Liang, nothing like the talkative person she had been on the phone before. Even the occasional glances she cast carried some awe and fear.

This wasn't normal.

Everything in this house was abnormal.

Although Liang Shi had lost her parents very early, she had lived with her grandparents before high school.

Normal families wouldn't have this kind of atmosphere.

It was like a strictly hierarchical institution.

Liang Shi pondered while returning to the bedroom.

The original owner's bedroom was on the innermost side of the third floor, with a password lock.

She entered the password, pushed open the door, and was stunned.

This bedroom was very dark - not the kind of darkness caused by external light, but a gloomy darkness.

The bedroom was airtight, with all the windows completely covered by curtains, but there was a fluorescent golden totem on the opposite wall - a wolf.

It looked especially like some kind of ritual².

She pressed the light switch and found that all the walls were black, and the carpet, bed sheets, quilt, and pillows were all black.

In the huge room, there were no extra decorations. The only thing that could be considered decoration was the lamp by the bedside.

But even the lamp's appearance was black.

The room's lighting wasn't bright incandescent bulbs or warm yellow light, but an indescribable, somewhat eerie spotlight.

More like the kind of lighting commonly seen in bars and clubs.

She pressed the switch several more times, and the lighting changed several times, but none were normal.

The most normal one was probably very dim, but could barely illuminate the entire room.

She suppressed the shock in her heart, walked into the room, and after closing the door, she actually felt a chill down her back.

So she went over to pull open the curtains, but she discovered that the curtains were just for show.

Behind the curtains was a wall, and on the wall were crisscrossing carved marks, with some writing stained with blood, looking very much like mystical symbols³.

This was a room without windows. According to Liang Shi's personality, why would she live in such a room?

There were many vacant rooms here, so why give her a room without windows?

And this room's decoration was too sinister, wasn't it?

Did Liang Shi decorate it like this herself, or did her family decorate it for her?

When she came up earlier, Lingdang had pulled her to the left side of the third floor. Through the slightly open door crack, she saw that Lingdang's room was very normal, with bright tones, warm and comfortable.

Liang Xinhe's room was also normal business person style.

Only the original owner's was like this.

Liang Shi didn't dare lie down on that bed, but now this was the only place where she could stay quietly.

So before dinner, she still had to stay in this room.

She might as well take this opportunity to look for any diary or similar things the original owner might have left behind.

Don't protagonists usually love writing diaries?

In the original owner's room closet, there was a neat pile of flashy clothes. She rummaged through them but didn't find anything. The bedside table was obviously empty at a glance, but in the bottom drawer she found two packs of cigarettes.

Just ordinary brands available on the market.

She searched the entire room but didn't find anything useful.

Getting a bit tired from searching, she simply sat on the carpet.

Looking up at the ceiling.

This room's ceiling construction was also different from ordinary ones. It was pure black, not a very flat shape, but that kind of downward-curving arch.

Liang Shi found it familiar, but couldn't say specifically where she'd seen it.

Her phone vibrated, and she took it out to look.

It was a browser notification with the headline: "Mountain Village Female Corpse Mysteriously Disappears, What Amazing Secret Lies Behind It!"

Total clickbait, but that picture attracted her attention.

Because the accompanying image was an opened coffin.

And this room's ceiling actually had striking similarities to that image.

Both were downward-curving arches, practically an enlarged version of the picture.

Footnotes:

¹ "Like she had thorns on her back" (如芒在背) - Chinese idiom meaning to feel very uncomfortable, as if being watched or criticized.

² "Ritual" (做法) - Refers to mystical or supernatural rituals, often associated with witchcraft or occult practices.

³ "Mystical symbols" (鬼畫符) - Literally "ghost drawings" or "demon talismans," referring to mysterious symbols that look like occult markings.